

As for colours, the average delta error is below the humanly perceptible value of 3, with the maximum error occurring at 100% white. Skin tones felt natural in both SDR and HDR content.

HDR PERFORMANCE

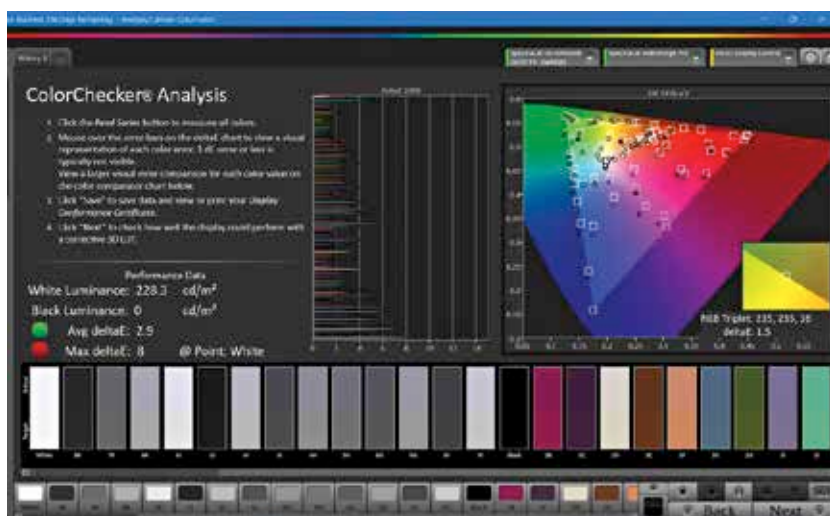
The Sony Bravia A80L supports HDR10, Dolby Vision, and HLG. It does not support HDR10+ and Dolby Vision IQ. However, we don't believe that is a deal breaker. Overall, the nuances of the HDR experience are handled really well. Dark scenes with some bright objects thrown in are rendered beautifully. Like all White OLED panels, it struggles in the near-black region. For example, you can notice a lot of artefacts in scenes where a meteor shoots through a grey sky. The overall peak brightness of the Sony Bravia A80L is on the conservative side, which is noticeable in less-than-dazzling highlights in bright HDR scenes.

We measured a peak brightness of 1080 Nits on a 1 per cent window using our lux meter in the vivid mode. In the custom mode, we measured around 700 nits on a 10% window measured and full field brightness measured 140 nits. This is better performance than last year's Sony Bravia A80K.

As seen in the chart above, greyscale in HDR content is still skewed toward blue. The Sony Bravia A80L accurately tracks the EOTF curve in HDR content, although it slightly undertracks the reference in dark scenes. Colours in HDR are once again quite accurate, with maximum error at the white point. We measured an average delta error of 3 which means that the colour inaccuracies will not be easily discernible to users. As for colour volume, we recorded 72.04% of BT2020 colour space in the XY terms and 73.67% in the UV term, which is again standard for the White OLED panels.

GAMING

With fast response time, fluid motion and VRR support, Sony Bravia A80L is quite good for gaming. The TV has two HDMI 2.1 ports, supports ALLM, and 120Hz VRR (NVIDIA G-Sync, AMD FreeSync Premium). Dolby Vision gaming is capped at 4K@60Hz. It also has a dedicated game



mode where you can pull up a game bar to quickly enable or disable VRR and access a few other settings.

High-end TVs from Samsung and LG come with some additional perks like 4 HDMI 2.1 ports and HGiG mode for accurate tone mapping in game mode.

AUDIO

Sony Bravia A80L uses Acoustic Surface Audio+ technology where the screen becomes the speaker and this adds a lot of realism to the experience. The 50W audio system includes three 10W actuators and two 10W sub-woofers.

This is certainly one of the best TV audio systems that we have experienced so far. Movie dialogues are crisp and clear, while the soundstage feels impressively expansive, occasionally simulating convincing surround sound effects. Additionally, the TV offers an auto-calibration option that employs a microphone in the remote control to gather data and optimize audio settings based on your typical viewing distance.

VERDICT

The Sony Bravia A80L is a premium OLED TV that boasts a range of Sony's proprietary image and video processing technologies, enhancing the cinematic experience. This television excels in handling legacy SD content and motion, ensuring amazing performance. Moreover, the HDR10 and Dolby Vision experiences are also mostly stunning, though we noticed that

highlights don't get bright enough to pop. Acoustic Surface Audio+ technology adds realism and further elevates the overall viewing experience.

It is worth noting that the Sony Bravia A80L lacks a colour-accurate Filmmaker mode. Additionally, with numerous technologies dynamically optimizing picture quality, it becomes challenging to determine if the original intent of the content creators is faithfully preserved.

As compared to other 2023 OLEDs, LG G3 and Sony A95K are expensive but offer a brighter OLED panel. If you are looking for a good deal, last year's Sony A80K offers a similar experience and is currently available at a competitive price.

—Deepak Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

Panel Size: 65-inch (also available in 55, 77 and 83-inch as well) | Panel Type: OLED (WRGB), 100Hz native refresh rate | Panel Resolution: 3840 x 2160 - 4K | Panel Refresh Rate: 120Hz | Supported HDR Formats: HDR10, HDR10+, HLG, Dolby Vision | Speakers: 50W Acoustic Surface Audio+ (3 Actuator + 2 Subwoofer) | Audio formats supported: Dolby Audio, Dolby Atmos, DTS Digital Surround | Software: Google TV | Weight (with stand): Approx. 24.3kgs | HDMI Ports: 4 (2 full bandwidth HDMI 2.1 ports - HDMI 3, HDMI 4) | HDMI 2.1 features - 4K@120, eARC, VRR, ALLM | Other connectivity options: 2 USB ports, Wi-Fi 5, Bluetooth 4.2, Ethernet, RF connection input, Headphone out, Digital audio out | Built-in storage: 16GB | Price: MRP: 3,49,990; Best Price: Rs 2,84,990

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